

Year 4 Maths - Addition and Subtraction Strategies

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0 Target

AC9M4N04 - use efficient strategies and appropriate representations to solve addition and subtraction problems with natural numbers.

Learning Intention

I can solve addition and subtraction problems using efficient written and mental strategies.

Maths Strategy

Estimate first. Then choose a strategy: split numbers, use a number line, or use a written algorithm.

Worked Example

Example: $468 + 257 = 468 + 200 + 50 + 7 = 725$. Check by estimating: $470 + 260$ is about 730.

Success Checklist

- ☐ I can estimate before solving.
- ☐ I can show my strategy.
- ☐ I can check whether my answer makes sense.

Mini Practice

Solve $326 + 148$ using two different strategies. Label each strategy.

Parent Quick Play

Make it real at home with coins, clocks, snacks, steps or prices. Keep the maths short, funny and low pressure.

Teacher Class Starter

Start with one modelled example. Ask students to explain the strategy before they calculate independently.

★ **Before you begin:** Read the example, say the strategy aloud, then try the mini practice. Mistakes are clues that help your brain grow.

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Page 2 - Practice and problem solving

Warm Up

1. $240 + 130 =$ _____
2. $705 - 200 =$ _____
3. Estimate: $398 + 214$ is close to _____

Build Your Skills

1. A school library has 486 fiction books and 238 information books. How many books are there altogether? _____
2. A bus travelled 924 km in two days. It travelled 487 km on the first day. How far did it travel on the second day? _____
3. Harper solved $563 - 279$ and got 394. Use estimation to explain why this may not be correct. _____

Strong Challenge

Write a real-life addition or subtraction problem where the answer is between 650 and 750. Solve it and show your strategy. _____

I Can Checklist

- ☐ I can choose an efficient strategy.
- ☐ I can show working clearly.
- ☐ I can check my answer with estimation.

Teacher Feedback

What went well:

Next step: _____

 **High Five!** You did not just find answers - you showed smart strategies. Be proud of your effort!

Year 4 Maths - Addition and Subtraction Strategies - Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Detailed Answers

1. Warm Up: 370; 505; about 600.
2. Library: $486 + 238 = 724$ books.
3. Bus: $924 - 487 = 437$ km.
4. Harper: $563 - 279$ is about $560 - 280 = 280$, so 394 is too high. Exact answer is 284.
5. Challenge: Answers vary; check operation, number sentence and reasonable working.

Parent Tip - At Home

Turn errands into quick maths: We have 420 steps to the park and walked 185. How many are left? Keep it playful and quick.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Ask students to estimate before calculating. This helps them catch unreasonable answers before marking.

Extension Idea

Solve the same problem using a number line and a written algorithm. Compare which method felt easier.